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Edit or remove a worker's time entry

This article is for:



ADMINISTRATORS



MANAGERS



TIME & ATTENDANCE

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Objective

Admins and individuals assigned the Time & Attendance manager permission profile (or designated approvers for legacy time tracking policies) can edit or remove an unapproved employee time entry. Learn more in this article about [Time & Attendance permission profiles](#). If you need to edit or remove a time entry that has already been approved, you'll need to restart the approval process. Keep in mind that edits to past time entries won't flow into payroll if they require an adjustment to the employee's pay, so you need to make these changes manually.

Edit an unapproved time entry

The instructions for how to edit an unapproved time entry vary depending on where you're viewing the time entry:

- The new Timesheets experience
- The legacy Timecards experience

Edit an unapproved time entry in the new Timesheets experience

To edit an unapproved time entry in the new Timesheets experience, follow these steps:

1. From the main sidebar, select **Time**.
2. From the *Time* sidebar, select **Timesheets**.
3. Search for the worker whose unapproved time entry you want to edit.
4. Optionally, use the options at the top to filter by country, pay schedule, schedule, and/or time range.
5. Click the **> arrow** to the far right of the timesheet that contains the time entry you want to edit.
6. To edit the time entry's start or end times, click in the *Start* and/or *End* cells and type in or select the appropriate times.

- To edit time entry details, such as a break, job, or schedule, click the item within the time entry's *Details* cell, make the necessary edits, and click Save. and click the **more icon** (three stacked dots) that appears.

Tracy David
04/27/2026 - 05/03/2026

Regular 40h 1.5x Overtime 12h 30m Approved/Total worked hours 45h/52h 30m

Holidays (paid) 0h Missed meal break premium 14h 17m

Day Activity

Day	Attributes	Start	End	Duration	Status and actions
Apr 27 Mon	⚠️ ⌚ 📅	2:51 AM	10:54 AM	7.98	Approved
Apr 28 Tue	⚠️ ⌚ 📅	2:55 AM	10:54 AM	7.98	Approved

paid break

Start date: 04/28/2026

Start time: 04:25 AM PDT

Duration: 15 minutes

Save

Time off (paid) 0h Time off (unpaid) 0h Last updated 01:29:23 PM

Show scheduled shifts

Cancel Save

- Click **Save** in the far right of the row.

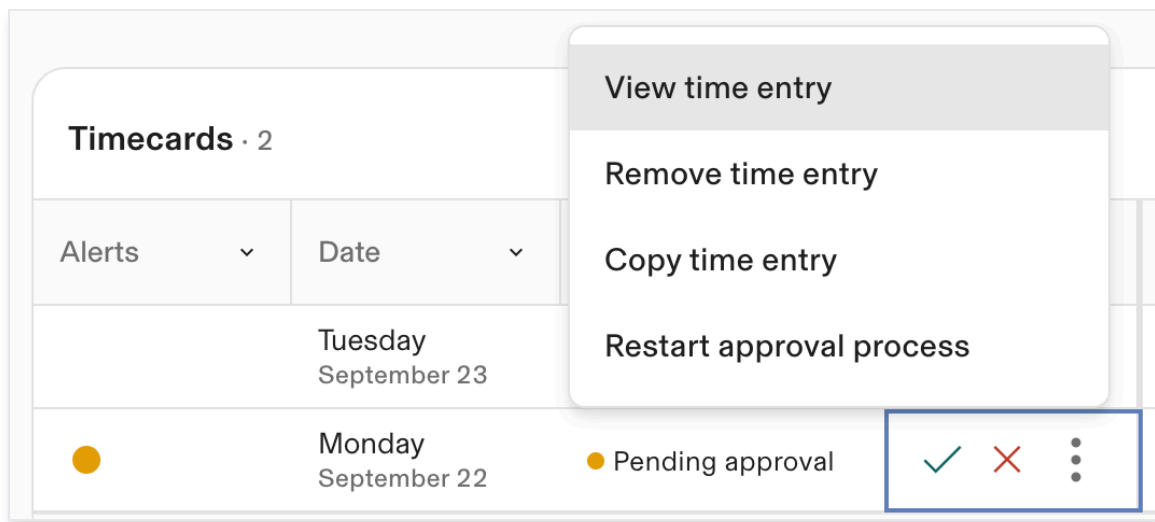
Edit an unapproved time entry in the legacy Timecards experience

To edit an unapproved time entry in the legacy Timecards experience, follow these steps:

- From the main sidebar, select **Time**.
- From the *Time* sidebar, select **Timecards**.
- Select the appropriate pay schedule.

Note: If employees are not assigned to a pay schedule in Payroll, they are displayed under the *No pay schedule* option in this drop down menu. Learn more in this article about [adding an employee to a pay schedule](#).

- Find the employee for which you want to edit their timecard and click their name.
- Find the time entry you want to edit and click the **more icon** (three dots) in its row.



6. Select **View time entry**.
7. Make changes to the timecard as needed.
8. To view changes made to the timecard, click the **Change History** tab.

Edit an approved time entry

If you need to make edits to a time entry that was already approved, you'll need to restart the approval process. Restarting the approval process will put the time entry back in a pending approval state. Any required approvers will need to approve the time entry again.

Note: You cannot restart the approval policy if payroll for the corresponding pay period has been approved but not yet paid out.

The instructions for how to edit an approved time entry vary depending on where you're viewing the time entry:

- The new Timesheets experience
- The legacy Timecards experience

Edit an approved time entry in the new Timesheets experience

To edit an approved time entry in the new Timesheets experience, follow these steps:

1. From the main sidebar, select **Time**.
2. From the *Time* sidebar, select **Timesheets**.
3. Search for the worker whose approved time entry you want to edit.
4. Optionally, use the options at the top to filter by country, pay schedule, schedule, and/or time range.
5. Click the **> arrow** to the far right of the timesheet that contains the time entry you want to edit.
6. Locate the time entry and click the **more icon** (three dots) in its row's *Status and actions* column.
7. Select **Restart approval process**.
8. Click **OK** to acknowledge that you want to restart the approval process and put this time entry back in a *Pending approval* state. Any required approvers will need to approve the time entry again.
9. To edit the time entry's start or end times, click in the *Start* and/or *End* cells and type in or select the appropriate times.
10. To edit time entry details, such as a break, job, or schedule, click the item within the time entry's *Details* cell, make the necessary edits, and click Save. and click the **more icon** (three stacked dots) that appears.

Tracy David
04/27/2026 - 05/03/2026

Regular 40h | 1.5x Overtime 12h 30m | Approved/Total worked hours 45h/52h 30m

Holidays (paid) 0h | Missed meal break premium 14h 17m

Day Activity

Day	Attributes	Start	End	Duration	Status and actions
Apr 27 Mon	⚠️ ⌚ 📅	2:51 AM	10:54 AM	7.98	Approved
Apr 28 Tue	⚠️ ⌚ 📅	2:55 AM	10:54 AM	7.98	Approved

paid break

Start date
04/28/2026

Start time
04:25 AM PDT

Duration
15 minutes

Save

29 minutes

15 minutes **30 minutes**

Cancel **Save**

Approve all **Change request**

Time off (paid) 0h **Time off (unpaid)** 0h

Last updated 01:29:23 PM

Show scheduled shifts

11. Click **Save** in the far right of the row.

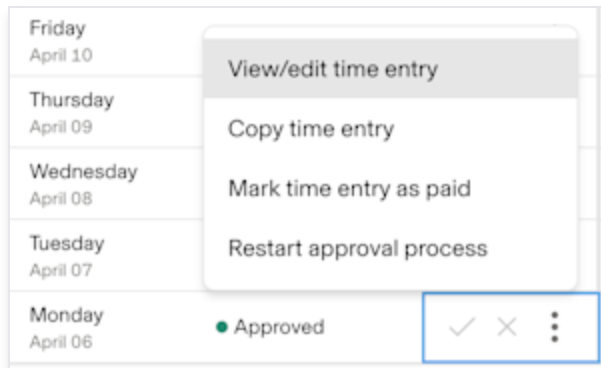
Edit an approved time entry in the legacy Timecards experience

To edit an approved time entry in the legacy Timecards experience, follow these steps:

1. From the main sidebar, select **Time**.
2. From the *Time* sidebar, select **Timecards**.
3. Select the appropriate pay schedule.

Note: If employees are not assigned to a pay schedule in Payroll, they are displayed under the *No pay schedule* option in this drop down menu. Learn more in this article about [adding an employee to a pay schedule](#).

4. Find the employee for which you want to review or edit their timecard and click their name.
5. Find the shift you want to edit and click the **three dots icon** in its row.
6. Select **View/edit time entry**.



7. Click **Edit clock in/out details** in the upper right.
8. Enter the updated time entry details.
9. Click **Save**.
10. Click **Restart approval process** to acknowledge that editing the time entry will nullify any current approvals or rejections on this time entry and initiate the approval process again.
11. Click **Save changes**.

Update the policies applied to a worker's time entry

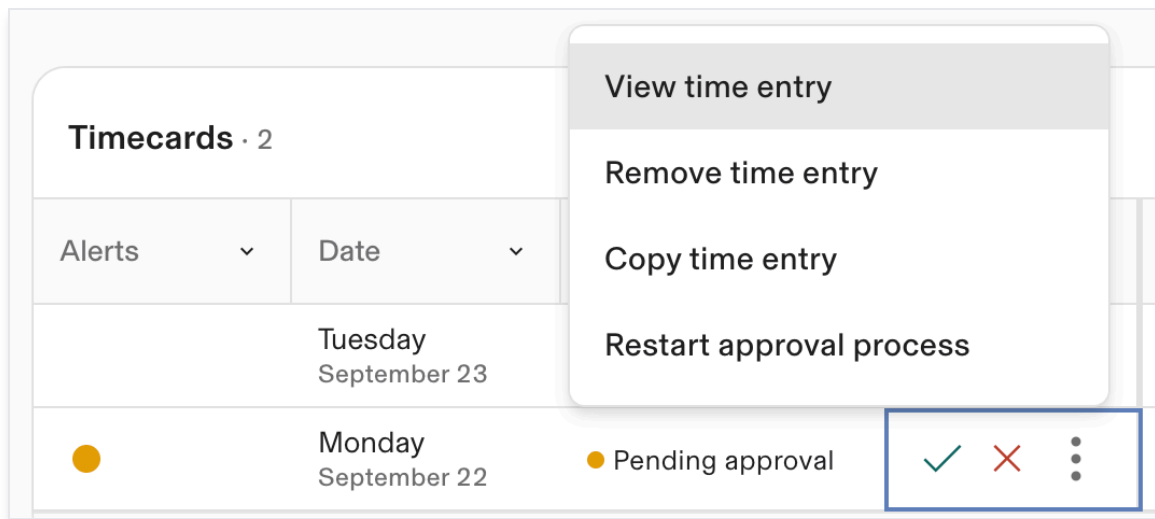
When a worker's time entry is in the *pending approval* status, super admins or admins with the full Time & Attendance permission profile can manually update the policies (break, time tracking, overtime, and custom pay policies) applied to the time entry.

Note: When a policy is updated, Rippling automatically recalculates time entries that have not been approved or paid by payroll to reflect the new policy configuration. Learn more in this article about [how policies are applied to time entries](#).

Note: This is currently only available in the legacy Timecards experience. To switch from the new Timesheets experience to the legacy Timecards experience, click **Switch to legacy Timecards** in the banner at the top of your screen. If you previously closed the banner, refresh your browser, and it will return.

To update the policies applied to a worker's time entry in the legacy Timecards experience, follow these steps:

1. From the main sidebar, select **Time**.
2. From the *Time* sidebar, select **Timecards**.
3. Select the appropriate pay schedule.
4. Find the employee for which you want to update the policies applied to their timecard and click their name.
5. Find the shift you want to edit and click the **three dots icon** in its row.



6. Select **View time entry**.
7. Select the **Policies applied to this timecard** sub-tab.
8. Click **Manually edit policies**.

Timecard policies   [Manually edit policies](#)

TIME TRACKING POLICY

Hourly Time Policy

 [View policy detail](#) 

OVERTIME POLICY

Default Overtime Policy: All Non-Exempt Employees | California

 [View policy detail](#) 

BREAK POLICY

Default Break Policy: All Employees | California

 [View policy detail](#) 

CUSTOM PAY POLICY

No policy

9. Select the break, time tracking, overtime, and/or custom pay policies that should apply to the shift.

Timecard policies

TIME TRACKING POLICY

Hourly Time Policy 

Default

Default time policy

Hourly Time Policy 

Copy of Hourly Time Policy

TOIL T&A Policy

Default T&A time policy

 [View policy detail](#) 

 [View policy detail](#) 

 [View policy detail](#) 

10. Click **Submit**.
11. Click **Yes, I'm sure** to confirm you understand that updating policies for this timecard will apply new policy rules for this entry.
12. Click **Done**.

Tip: If a worker is unable to choose breaks on their timecard, follow the steps above to verify that a break policy is applied to the timecard.

Remove a time entry

All time entries within a timesheet or timecard must be approved in order for the timecard or timesheet to be approved. You can remove unapproved time entries that

were added by mistake.

Tip: If the time entry was approved by mistake, you must restart the approval process before removing the time entry. Learn more in the *Edit an approved time entry* section above.

The instructions for how to remove a time entry vary depending on where you're viewing the time entry:

- The new Timesheets experience
- The legacy Timecards experience

Remove a time entry in the new Timesheets experience

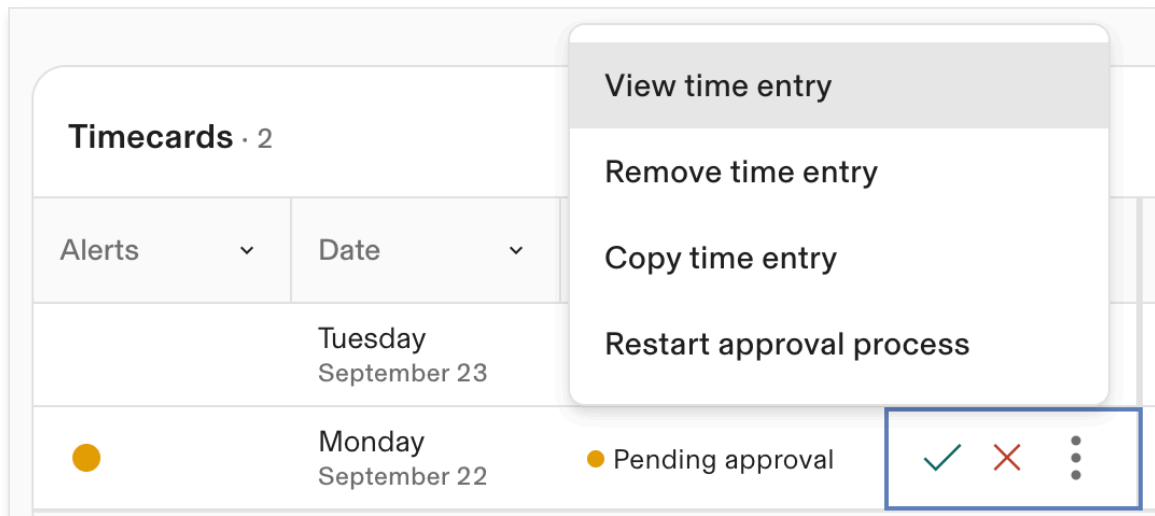
To remove an unapproved time entry in the new Timesheets experience, follow these steps:

1. From the main sidebar, select **Time**.
2. From the *Time* sidebar, select **Timesheets**.
3. Search for the worker for whom you want to remove a time entry.
4. Optionally, use the options at the top to filter by country, pay schedule, schedule, and/or time range.
5. Click the **> arrow** to the far right of the timesheet that contains the time entry you want to remove.
6. Click time entry's **more icon** (three stacked dots).
7. Select **Remove time entry**.
8. Click **Remove** to confirm you want to remove the time entry. This action is permanent and can not be reversed.

Remove a time entry in the legacy Timecards experience

To remove an unapproved time entry in the legacy Timecards experience, follow these steps:

1. From the main sidebar, select **Time**.
2. From the *Time* sidebar, select **Timecards**.
3. Find the employee for which you want to remove a time entry and click their name.
4. Find the time entry you want to remove and click the **three dots icon** in its row.



5. Select **Remove time entry**.
6. Click **Remove** to confirm you want to remove the time entry. This action is permanent and can not be reversed.

The timecard's status changes to approved once the unapproved time entry is removed.

Frequently asked questions

Why can't I edit a job, meal break, or unpaid break?

If a job, meal break, or unpaid break shows as "locked" and says *You are no longer eligible for this break type*, this means that the employee was changed from one policy to another mid-pay period. Because of this, you will want to make any changes under the new (or "unlocked") break type.



How do I remove sick time from a timecard?

If someone submitted a sick leave request but did not end up taking it, you will likely want to remove it from their timecard to ensure their working hours are calculated correctly. To remove sick leave from a timecard, you must cancel the sick leave request. To cancel an approved sick leave request, find the sick leave request under **Time > Approvals > All requests** tab > **Time off** sub-tab and cancel the request. For more detailed instructions, refer to our article on [approving and managing time off requests](#).

Why are employees notified when I edit their timecards?

Notifications are sent to employees when an admin edits their timecard and includes a comment. The notification is triggered based on the comment, not the edit itself. This usually occurs when the time tracking policy requires comments for manual timecard edits.

To review the employee's time tracking policy setup, navigate to **Time > Time Settings** (or **Policies** if you are on the old Time policies experience) > **Time tracking** > click **Edit** associated with the appropriate time tracking policy and review its configuration of the *Require a comment for every manual timecard edit, including removals* setting in the *Time tracking settings* section. Learn more about the the *Require a comment for every manual timecard edit, including removals* setting in this article about [setting up a time tracking policy](#).

If the time tracking policy does not require comments for manual timecard edits, admins can edit timecards without adding comments, and no notifications will be sent to the employee.

You can also disable time tracking comment notifications for the entire company. Learn more in this article about [managing your company's notification preferences](#).

Can I remove holiday hours from a timesheet or timecard?

You cannot remove holiday hours from a timesheet or time card if the employee is assigned to a holiday policy. Holiday hours are automatically added to an employee's timesheet or timecard if they are assigned to a holiday policy that defines those holidays.

To remove automatically populated holiday hours, you must remove the employee from the holiday policy. Once the employee is no longer assigned to the holiday policy, Rippling will remove the policy's holiday hours from their timesheets or timecards. This action requires permissions typically granted to an administrator or Time admin who manages employee policies.

Can I edit a time entry in the paid status?

No. Time entries in the *Paid* status cannot be edited. Details such as clock-in time, clock-out time, and break durations are locked. This ensures the accuracy of your financial records and prevents discrepancies between approved payroll and employee time cards.

Can I add time off for a terminated employee so it appears on their timecards?

No. Once an employee's app access is revoked during offboarding, they are removed from all time off policies. As a result, neither the employee nor an admin can request or add time off for them, and it will not appear on their timecards.

See also

Learn more in these related articles:

- [Overview of employee timecards](#)

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